

SWIFT

An alternative language to develop iOS and OS X applications removes the C(omplexity) from Objective-C

The birth of Swift comes after a realisation that many programming neophytes find it difficult to code in Objective-C because of its untangled pointers, file handling and the punctuation-rich syntax. Announced in June 2014 at the World Wide Developers Conference, Swift makes its place next to Objective-C to work with Apple's Cocoa and Cocoa Touch frameworks and the large body of existing Objective-C code written for Apple products.

Chris Lattner - the primary author of LLVM (Low Level Virtual Machine) project, began development in 2010 in collaboration with many other programmers. It took ideas from Objective-C, Rust, Haskell, Ruby, Python, C#, CLU and many others. With the newly introduced language, Apple hopes that programmers who have learnt Java, JavaScript, or Ruby will find many similarities in Swift that will help them master the language without much difficulty.

The basic structure of Swift is similar to Java. The entire code is divided into classes which comprises of fields and methods. What sets it apart from Java is the declaration of the syntax and other simplified features. For example a function declaration starts with a keyword (func) and return value comes after the method name, not before it, unlike Java.